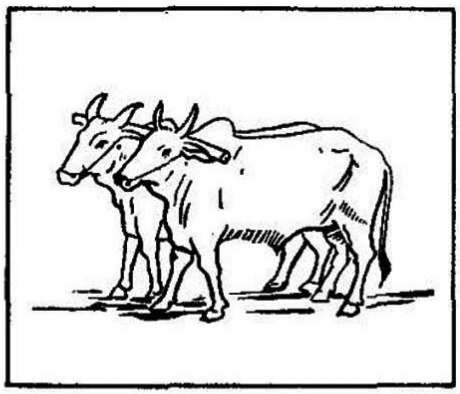


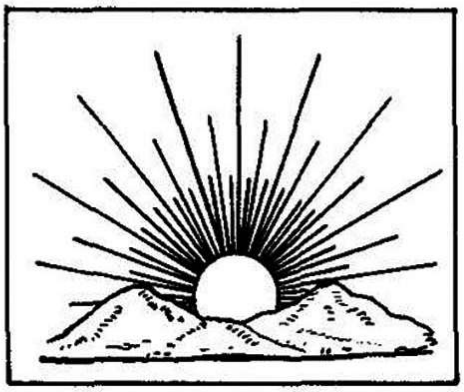
ALL INDIA BHARTIYA JAN SANGH



INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS



AKHIL BHARTIYA HINDU MAHASABHA



AKHIL BHARTIYA RAM RAJYA PARISHAD

The Jan Sangh adopted the Hindu lamp of purity as its election symbol. The Hindu Mahasabha poll symbol featured a Hindu warrior on horseback while the Ram Rajya Parishad, which promised to usher in the rule of Ram, showcased a rising sun. Nehru, in his campaigning, with the Congress poll symbol of two bullocks defined the contest as a battle against the combined forces of Hindu nationalism: referring to these parties and RSS as one category. Poll symbols from ECI.

'The stronger the Jan Sangh is growing,' he declared, 'more infuriated is Mr Nehru. I do not mind his criticisms of our programme or policy but he is now indulging in fantastic allegations which have no relation to the truth. For instance, in his Allahabad speech, he is reported to have said that Jan Sangh is being supported by Princes and Jagirdars in Rajasthan. This is the reverse of truth. The Jan Sangh has evoked spontaneous support from large sections of the masses whose interest the Party has undertaken to promote.'[59]

This early exchange typified India's template of secular vs Hindu nationalist politics in the first few years after independence. If